

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY

 **ACTOR REPORT**

**PatchWork gang dropped a variant of the
BADNEWS Trojan**

Date of Publication

January 10, 2023

Admiralty Code

A1

TA Number

TA2023016

Summary

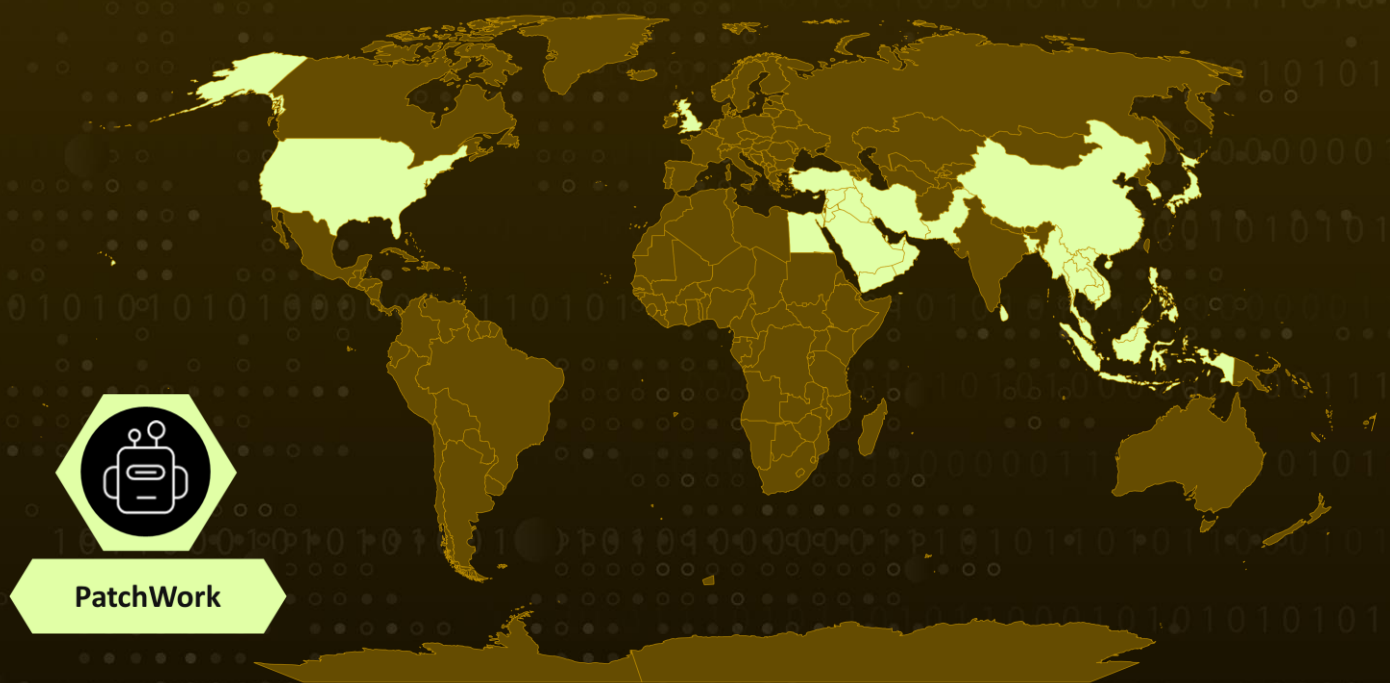
First Appearance: December 2015

Actor Name: PatchWork

Target Region: Bangladesh, China, Japan, Pakistan, South Korea, Sri Lanka, UK, USA, Akrotiri and Dhekelia, Bahrain, Cyprus, Egypt, Iran, Iraq, Israel, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Oman, Palestine, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Syria, Turkey, UAE, Yemen, Brunei, Myanmar, Cambodia, Timor-Leste, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, Vietnam.

Target Sectors: Aviation, Defense, Energy, Financial, Government, IT, Media, NGOs, Pharmaceutical, and Think Tanks.

Actor Map



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Actor Details

#1

Patchwork is an Indian threat actor that has been active since December 2015 and typically targets Pakistan via spear-phishing strikes. The group primarily employs harpoon assaults, reinforced by a small number of watering-hole attacks, to steal sensitive information from the government, military, power, industry, diplomacy, and economy sectors.

#2

Patchwork deployed a variant of the BADNEWS (Ragnatela) Remote Administration Trojan that employed malicious RTF files in its most recent campaign. The group's project name and control panel are named "Ragnatela," which means "spider web" in Italian. The RAT is capable of executing commands through cmd, taking screenshots, logging keystrokes, collecting a list of folders on the victim's PC, and downloading additional payloads.

#3

The final payload, the BADNEWS Trojan, is placed as an OLE object within the RTF document and uses a stolen digital signature. When executed, the Ragnatela RAT communicates with the attacker's infrastructure via a server.

Actor Group

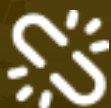
NAME	ORIGIN	TARGET REGIONS	TARGET INDUSTRIES
Patchwork (Dropping Elephant, Chinastrats, APT-C-09, Monsoon, Quilted Tiger, TG-4410, Zinc Emerson, ATK 11, Confucius, EHDevel, Manul, Operation Hangover, Viceroy Tiger, Mahabusa)	India	Bangladesh, China, Japan, Pakistan, South Korea, Sri Lanka, UK, USA, Akrotiri and Dhekelia, Bahrain, Cyprus, Egypt, Iran, Iraq, Israel, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Oman, Palestine, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Syria, Turkey, UAE, Yemen, Brunei, Myanmar, Cambodia, Timor-Leste, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, Vietnam.	Aviation, Defense, Energy, Financial, Government, IT, Media, NGOs, Pharmaceutical, and Think Tanks.
	MOTIVE		
	Information theft and espionage		

Recommendations



Security Leaders

Phishing simulations and routine education and awareness training and communications rarely account for MFA fatigue and web browser hygiene. Integrate and communicate all lessons learned.



Security Engineers

- **Uni5 Users:** This is an actionable threat advisory in HivePro Uni5. Prioritize and block all indicators attributed to the threat actors and attacks through your Command Center. Test your controls with Uni5's Breach & Attack Simulation.
- **All Engineers:** Refer to and action upon the 'Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs' & 'Indicators of Compromise (IoC)' on the following pages.



Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0042</u> Resource Development	<u>TA0001</u> Initial Access	<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0003</u> Persistence
<u>TA0004</u> Privilege Escalation	<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion	<u>TA0006</u> Credential Access	<u>TA0007</u> Discovery
<u>TA0008</u> Lateral Movement	<u>TA0009</u> Collection	<u>TA0010</u> Exfiltration	<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control
<u>T1548</u> Abuse Elevation Control Mechanism	<u>T1548.002</u> Bypass User Account Control	<u>T1560</u> Archive Collected Data	<u>T1119</u> Automated Collection
<u>T1197</u> BITS Jobs	<u>T1547</u> Boot or Logon Autostart Execution	<u>T1547.001</u> Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder	<u>T1059</u> Command and Scripting Interpreter
<u>T1059.001</u> PowerShell	<u>T1059.003</u> Windows Command Shell	<u>T1059.005</u> Visual Basic	<u>T1555</u> Credentials from Password Stores
<u>T1555.003</u> Credentials from Web Browsers	<u>T1132</u> Data Encoding	<u>T1132.001</u> Standard Encoding	<u>T1005</u> Data from Local System
<u>T1074</u> Data Staged	<u>T1074.001</u> Local Data Staging	<u>T1587</u> Develop Capabilities	<u>T1587.002</u> Code Signing Certificates
<u>T1189</u> Drive-by Compromise	<u>T1203</u> Exploitation for Client Execution	<u>T1083</u> File and Directory Discovery	<u>T1574</u> Hijack Execution Flow

<u>T1574.002</u> DLL Side-Loading	<u>T1070</u> Indicator Removal	<u>T1070.004</u> File Deletion	<u>T1105</u> Ingress Tool Transfer
<u>T1559</u> Inter-Process Communication	<u>T1559.002</u> Dynamic Data Exchange	<u>T1036</u> Masquerading	<u>T1036.005</u> Match Legitimate Name or Location
<u>T1112</u> Modify Registry	<u>T1027</u> Obfuscated Files or Information	<u>T1588</u> Obtain Capabilities	<u>T1566</u> Phishing
<u>T1055</u> Process Injection	<u>T1021</u> Remote Services	<u>T1053</u> Scheduled Task/Job	<u>T1553</u> Subvert Trust Controls
<u>T1204</u> User Execution	<u>T1204.001</u> Malicious Link	<u>T1204.002</u> Malicious File	<u>T1102</u> Web Service

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
SHA256	79bde77f2295dbf272b4138db3b42a8e40e67201da5f7a70de1600c15ebfc81e 2be095b201379123f11fd66b382aee0ca9542e3061fa129bc53c1eddd9b895c3
MD5	61968f25ace9464a0f9fffc6d87ffdcf 636ce29c9b4265fe8255459d33db99c8
SHA1	69565769c206c4b3daf1251e5f2ff82017fdb8b8 7f70f78730a1d147d845e3af88bc4417510d1f4e
Domain	Bingoplant[.]live

References

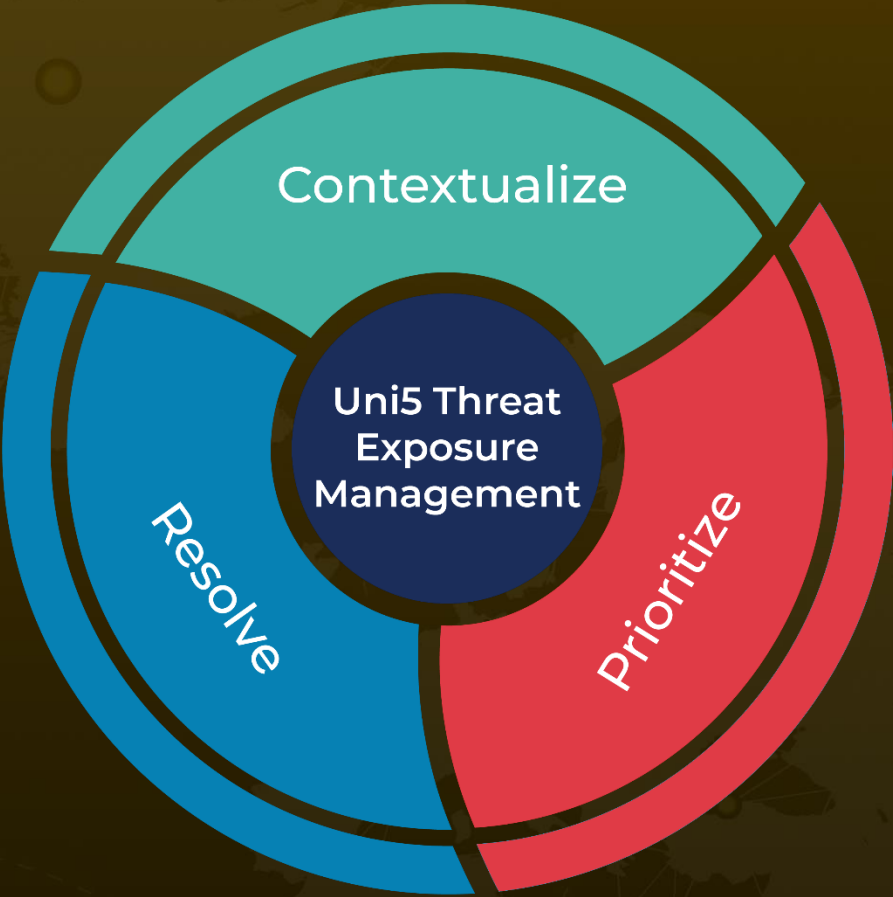
<https://www.rewterz.com/rewterz-news/rewterz-threat-alert-patchwork-apt-group-targeting-pakistan-active-iocs-4>

<https://attack.mitre.org/groups/G0040/>

What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with HivePro Uni5: Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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